I had a similar experience when working. My coworkers teased me frequently about my “Pap-mobile,” a 2003 Chevy Malibu with cloth seats that I inherited from my grandfather when he could no longer drive. I drove that inherited car for nearly a decade while pursuing FI. Over that same period of time, I spent considerable money traveling the world in pursuit of outdoor adventures and other experiences, including major sporting events and music festivals. I value those experiences, but I don’t value fancy cars. So my time and money went to travel, adventure, and experiences while still saving a lot of money by driving a crappy car. I’m a valuist.

Brad

> The simplest lever my wife and I have pulled on the path to FI is that we drive old cars. My wife Laura drives a 2003 Toyota Highlander, and I drive a 2003 Honda Civic. Each has over 100,000 miles, they still drive great, and both look nice. The best part is we haven’t had a car payment on each in roughly 10 years!
>
> We’ve taken the $700 per month we would have spent on new or leased cars and invested that money in the stock market in low-cost index funds. We now estimate our net worth